HIGHLIGHTS OF CABINET MEETING – FRIDAY 12 DECEMBER 2025

1. Cabinet has agreed to a monthly salary compensation of Rs635, i.e., 3.7 per cent of the National Minimum Wage, being paid to employees earning a monthly basic salary of up to Rs50,000 as from 01 January 2026.

This decision follows discussions held on 11 December 2025 during the Tripartite Committee Meeting on Salary Compensation, under the chair of the Prime Minister. Some 409,400 employees will benefit from the salary compensation, of whom 89,100 in the public sector and 320,300 in the private sector. 88 per cent of employees in the economy will benefit from the salary compensation. The annual cost of the salary compensation is estimated at Rs3.38 billion, of which Rs740 million for the public sector and Rs2.64 billion for the private sector.

Cabinet has further taken note that despite the tight fiscal situation, an increase of 3.7 per cent will be granted to all beneficiaries of basic pensions, including beneficiaries of basic retirement pension, widow's basic pension, invalid's basic pension and orphan's pension, as from 01 January 2026. Furthermore, the increase will also apply to all eligible beneficiaries of income support, i.e., those having reached 60 years but not eligible for the basic retirement pension. These measures will cover more than 325,000 beneficiaries and will cost Rs2.4 billion annually.

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2. Cabinet has taken note of the circumstances surrounding the death of late detainee Andy Selmour, aged 33, at the Melrose Prison on 09 December 2025, and taking into consideration that it is a matter of public concern, has agreed to a Board of Inquiry to be chaired by former Judge Mr Paul Lam Shang Leen being set up under section 3(1)(a) of the Public Inquiries Act to enquire into the case.

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3. Cabinet has taken note of the outcome of discussions held during meetings of the Ministerial Committee set up to examine the sustainability of the Bus Companies Recovery Account, and has agreed to the introduction of a temporary support scheme for bus operators. The Support Scheme equivalent to Rs252 million, and which will apply to the current financial year, will provide targeted and efficient financial support to the bus industry, while mitigating potential revenue leakages to the operators.

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4. Cabinet has taken note that the night market in Port Louis starting from 12 December 2025 up to 05 January 2026, will be extended to three additional roads, namely Bourbon Street, Jummah Mosque Street and Joseph Rivière Street, in view of the high demand for stalls.

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5. Cabinet has taken note that in a decision dated 02 December 2025 and published on 08 December 2025, the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination has expressed concern that the bilateral agreement between the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and the Republic of Mauritius regarding the Chagos Archipelago does not guarantee, inter alia, the rights of Chagossian people to full reparation, particularly with regard to compensation, satisfaction and guarantees of non-repetition. The Committee thus called on both Mauritius and the United Kingdom to suspend ratification of the agreement, and to engage immediately in a renewed dialogue to ensure the free, prior and informed consent of the Chagossian people, and to respect their rights, including the right to return to Diego Garcia, the right to self-determination through meaningful participation in all decision-making processes. It also asked both States Parties to guarantee access to effective remedies and full reparation.

Cabinet has further taken note that in a letter dated 10 December 2025 addressed to the Chairperson of the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination, the Embassy of the Republic of Mauritius and Permanent Mission to the United Nations and other International Organisations in Geneva has deplored the decision of the Committee and expressed the view that it not only goes against the grain of the International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination, but also causes serious prejudice to the Republic of Mauritius as a sovereign state and baffles the principles of the rule of law and natural justice. Attention has been drawn to the fact that the Agreement which the Governments of Mauritius and the United Kingdom signed on 22 May 2025 concerning the Chagos Archipelago including Diego Garcia addresses the wrongs of the past. Both the Governments of the Republic of Mauritius and of the United Kingdom have committed to supporting Chagossian communities. This will include visits for those of Chagossian descent to the Chagos Archipelago, including Diego Garcia. It has also been highlighted that members of the Chagossian community themselves have said that the Agreement between the Governments of Mauritius and of the United Kingdom is the only viable path to a Mauritian-led programme of resettlement. A request has thus been made to the Chairperson of the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination for the rejoinder from the Republic of Mauritius to be published on the website of the Committee alongside its Decision of 02 December 2025.

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6. Cabinet has agreed to the introduction of the Trust Fund for the Benefit of Chagossians Bill into the National Assembly. The object of the Bill is to set up, for the benefit of Chagossians, a Trust Fund which will be capitalised by the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland in the sum of 40 million pounds sterling pursuant to Article 11(1)(b) of the Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Mauritius and the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland concerning the Chagos Archipelago, including Diego Garcia signed on 22 May 2025 in Port Louis and London.

The Fund shall be established as a statutory body and shall be managed by a Board consisting of seven persons of Chagossian origin, out of 12, one of whom shall be its Chairperson. The British High Commissioner or his representative shall be entitled to attend meetings of the Board.

The purpose of the Fund shall be to devise and implement projects for the benefit of Chagossians. There shall accordingly be set up, for that purpose, a Projects Subcommittee of the Board that will draw from the competencies of members in the fields of applied social science and project management.

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7. Cabinet has agreed to the promulgation of the Public Procurement (Amendment) Regulations 2025, in line with the measures announced in Budget 2025-2026, to provide for, inter alia –

(a) the reservation of public contract for works of up to Rs50 million for microenterprises, small enterprises and medium enterprises;

(b) a medium enterprise, which has an annual turnover not exceeding Rs100 million, to be eligible to bid for any contract above Rs30 million, but not exceeding Rs50 million; and

(c) the definition of "medium enterprise" which will have the same meaning as in the Small and Medium Enterprises Act, that is, having an annual turnover above Rs30 million but not exceeding Rs100 million.

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8. Cabinet has agreed to the promulgation of the Construction Industry Authority (Amendment of Schedule) Regulations 2025. The purpose of the Construction Industry Authority (Amendment of Schedule) Regulations 2025 is to amend the list of construction materials that fall under mandatory registration so that it includes additional items such as tiles, granite, concrete drains and kerbs, electrical and plumbing materials, floorings, glass, glass reinforced polyester, photovoltaic panels, water pipes and fittings. These Regulations will also provide for construction tradesmen, namely Air conditioning Technician, Electrician, Plumber, Painter, Welder and Interior Decorator to be registered with the Construction Industry Authority, in order to practise in Mauritius.

Cabinet has also agreed to the promulgation of the Construction Industry Development Board (Registration of Consultants and Contractors) (Amendment) Regulations 2025, to, inter alia, prescribe fees for the registration of different categories of contractors and consultants, following the review of the grading structure of contractors in the Finance Bill 2025.

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9. Cabinet has agreed to drafting instructions being conveyed to the Attorney-General's Office for the preparation of a Student Recruitment Agencies Bill. Presently, the recruitment of Mauritian students for admission to overseas educational and training institutes is governed by the Licensing of Recruiting Agents for Overseas Educational and Training Institutions Act. However, recruitment activities for international students to study in Mauritius are not regulated. This vacuum is being exploited by unscrupulous intermediaries and exposing vulnerable young people to significant risks.

The Student Recruitment Agencies Bill will accordingly provide for, inter alia, the following -

(a) comprehensive licensing, fit-and-proper monitoring and enforcement regime for education agents engaged in both outbound and inbound student recruitment;

(b) all education agents to be incorporated companies, to meet probity and competency standards, to maintain proper records and to comply with student-protection obligations; and

(c) clear prohibitions on misleading advertising, undisclosed fees, false promises of employment or guaranteed visas.

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10. Cabinet has agreed to the Government of Mauritius signing a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Indian Ocean Commission for the financing and implementation of regional coordinated actions at sea under the Safe Seas Africa Programme.

The MoU is a continuation of the previous cooperation framework under the MASE Programme, and will provide for uninterrupted support for maritime security operations, sustained EU-funded financing, and ongoing participation in the Regional Maritime Security Architecture. It will formalise cooperation between Mauritius and the Indian Ocean Commission within the framework of the Regional Maritime Security Architecture funded by the European Union.

The MoU will strengthen the capacity of the Mauritius Police Force to conduct coordinated patrols, surveillance missions, and other actions at sea under the coordination of the Regional Centre for Operational Coordination. It will also enable Mauritius to benefit from renewed funding of up to EUR2 million for eligible actions at sea.

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11. Cabinet has agreed to the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding between the National Bureau of Statistics of the Republic of Seychelles and Statistics Mauritius, with the objectives to –

(a) establish a practical framework for cooperation with regard to improvement in the production and dissemination of high-quality official statistics; and

(b) strengthen institutional relations and capacity building through cooperation.

The Memorandum of Understanding provides for the two institutions to collaborate through, amongst others, staff training and development; exchange of technical advice, expertise and cooperation in research projects; provision of technical advice in their respective sector of expertise; and participation of staff in working groups, technical committees and workshops.

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12. Cabinet has agreed to the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding between the Vector Biology and Control Division of the Ministry of Health and Wellness and the Mauritius Meteorological Services.

The objective of the Memorandum of Understanding is to establish a cooperative agreement between the parties, whereby the Mauritius Meteorological Services would provide daily rainfall and temperature data collected from a network of its Automatic Weather Stations to the Vector Biology and Control Division to feed its predictive mosquito abundance modelling software "ALBOMAURICE/ARBOCARTO".

"ALBOMAURICE/ARBOCARTO" is a standalone application which has been designed to anticipate the density of *Aedes albopictus* mosquitoes in geographic areas of the island of Mauritius by using the temperature and rainfall data of 30 meteo stations from the Mauritius Meteorological Services. It aims to enhance existing mosquito surveillance and control programmes of the Ministry of Health and Wellness, to mitigate the spread of diseases such as dengue and chikungunya.

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13. Cabinet has taken note that Deepavali was, on 10 December 2025, inscribed on the UNESCO Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity at the 20th Session of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage which is currently being held in New Delhi, India.

Deepavali already features in the National Inventory of Intangible Cultural Heritage of the National Heritage Fund. This international recognition will now enhance the visibility of the festival globally and will strengthen cultural cooperation with India as well as create opportunities to develop heritage-based cultural initiatives.

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14. Cabinet has agreed to Mauritius co-hosting with the *Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit* (GIZ) and the NDC Partnership, a Regional Forum for Practitioners in Small Island Developing States (SIDS) on Advancing Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC) 3.0 Implementation Readiness, from 24 to 26 February 2026 in Mauritius.

The objective of the Regional Forum is to strengthen regional cooperation for enhancing climate action in SIDS of the Western Indian Ocean, which are members of the NDC Partnership and which have accordingly benefitted from the support of the GIZ in the preparation of their respective NDC 3.0 Roadmap. The Regional Forum will moreover serve as a strategic platform for SIDS in the Western Indian Ocean region to connect, collaborate and co-develop solutions for accelerating the implementation of their NDCs while addressing approaches to unlock the financial resources required. The Forum is expected to gather around 70 participants from countries of the region, namely, Comoros, Seychelles, Madagascar and Zanzibar.

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15. Cabinet has agreed to the setting up of a National Arts Open Commission, as enunciated in the Government Programme 2025-2029. The National Arts Open Commission, which will be set up administratively, will, inter alia, –

(a) advise the Ministry of Arts and Culture on the formulation of a comprehensive policy on arts and culture based, among others, on national consultations and inputs from the "Convention Nationale sur les Arts et la Culture";

(b) recommend a coherent national policy including legal framework to support the arts and creative sectors aligned with international conventions and propose recommendations in line with existing legislation;

(c) propose mechanisms to recognise and protect the rights of cultural workers as defined by the United Nations and recommend measures to improve their working conditions, visibility and economic contribution;

(d) propose a national creative industry development strategy positioning culture as a driver of economic growth and innovation; and

(e) recommend measures for the preservation, adaptive use and valorisation of national heritage sites, including the development of local economic development plans around major cultural and heritage assets.

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16. Cabinet has taken note of the introduction of the drug use prevention programme, commonly known as 'Get Connected Programme', as from Grade 7 in secondary schools, starting academic year 2026. The programme will span over a period of two years, with the first six lessons being taught in Grade 7 and the remaining six in Grade 8.

The Get Connected Programme, which was introduced in Mauritius in 2019, is aligned with the International Standards on Drug Use Prevention developed jointly by the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime and the World Health Organization. It aims to equip learners with essential life skills and sound knowledge to help them make informed decisions as well as resist peer pressure associated with substance use, other risky behaviours and illicit drug use through life skills development and participatory learning.

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17. Cabinet has taken note of the results of the National Certificate of Education (NCE) Assessment for the year 2025. Out of the 15,047 candidates of the Regular and Extended Programme of the Republic of Mauritius who were examined, 10,598 candidates have met the requirements for the award of NCE, representing a pass rate of 70.43 per cent for the 2025 cohort.

On the island of Mauritius, 14,232 candidates took part in the NCE Assessment 2025, out of whom 10,127 met the NCE requirements, representing a pass rate of 71.16 per cent. In Rodrigues, 806 candidates took part in the NCE Assessment, of whom 467 candidates attained the NCE requirements, representing a success rate of 57.94 per cent. In Agalega, out of the nine school candidates who were examined for the NCE Assessment 2025, four attained the NCE requirements, representing a pass rate of 44.44 per cent. Out of the 1,460 Grade 9⁺ Extended Programme candidates who have been examined for the year 2025, 78 candidates have qualified for the NCE, representing a percentage pass rate of 5.3 per cent of the total Extended Programme cohort for the Republic of Mauritius.

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18. Cabinet has taken note of the temporary closure of the National History Museum, Mahébourg, by the Mauritius Museums Council as from 15 December 2025, in view of the cyclonic season and the urgent need to safeguard the collections pending the replacement of its severely deteriorated roof structure.

Arrangements are currently being made to transfer the most valuable artefacts found in the National History Museum, Mahébourg, to the Natural History Museum, Port Louis. Other artefacts will be transferred to the Peopling of Mauritius Museum at Pointe Canon. In parallel to the transfer exercise, the Ministry of Arts and Culture is finalising the scope of works for the launching of bids for the replacement of the roof.

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19. Cabinet has taken note that the Inter-Ministerial Committee set up under the chair of the Minister of Social Integration, Social Security and National Solidarity to oversee, coordinate and monitor the effective implementation of the recommendations made by the United Nations Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities in its Concluding Observations within the framework of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, will meet on Tuesday 16 December 2025.

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20. Cabinet has taken note of the reconstitution of the Board of Directors of the Mauritius Shipping Corporation Ltd, with Mr Vinayeghen Govindasami as part-time Chairperson. Cabinet has further taken note that Mr Sanjaye Dabydoyal has been appointed as Managing Director of the Mauritius Shipping Corporation Ltd.

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